

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter School Overview

California — PERB(CA) Jurisdiction — June 7, 2026

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Section 1: State Overview

State	California
Labor Board	PERB(CA) — California Public Employment Relations Board
Governing Law	Educational Employment Relations Act (EERA), Gov. Code §3540 et seq.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	Limited — NLRB applies only to independently incorporated nonprofit charters that successfully argue private employer status. Two documented cases: St. HOPE Public Schools (NLRB R20, March 2026 — landmark NRTW decertification); Gompers Preparatory Academy (PERB decert pathway, June 2023). All other CA charters: PERB(CA) jurisdiction.
Right-to-Work	NOT a Right-to-Work State — Gov. Code §3540 et seq. (EERA) (Not a right-to-work state. EERA governs public-employer charters.)
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	NO — Secret ballot election required.
Registry Sweep	COMPLETE — May 9, 2026 — 1246 charter schools searched
Research Window	2024–June 2026 (Registry v44 PERB(CA) scan: May 9, 2026; CA Integration: June 4, 2026)

Section 2: Charter School Landscape

Total charter schools in California: 1246 (Charter School Registry v86 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 1,246 open schools as of June 2026)). Unionization census figures reflect confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
Total Organized Charter Schools in California	302	24.2%	All CA charter schools where staff have union coverage: 194 independently organized + 113 structurally covered (DEPENDENT). Denominator: 1,246 open CA charter schools (Registry v86). Verified by extraction across all 20 Tier 1 files, June 7, 2026 (post Gap A resolution).
Independently Organized (UNIONIZED/INDEPENDENT)	189	15.2%	School-specific PERB(CA) or NLRB certification. CMO networks: Green Dot/AMU (16), HTH/HTEC (16), CAVA (9), Summit (4), Alliance (23), CWC (5), Enviro Charter (4), Caliber (2). Individual schools: confirmed_individual (24), 80school_confirmed_v1 (79), discoveries (6), lausd active (5). Excludes 5 CLOSED/HISTORICALLY_ORGANIZED reversion schools and 3 CLOSED/INDEPENDENT records.

Structurally Covered (DEPENDENT/STRUCTURAL_DISTRICT)	113	9.1%	LAUSD Horace Mann (48) + dependent district clusters (39 + 17 + 9 = 65). No individual school election or PERB certification event. Coverage is structural via district employer-of-record and master CBA. Verified across 4 DEPENDENT Tier 1 files.
Closed — Historically Organized (PDR-010 Reversion)	5	0.4%	Calahan Community Charter, Chandler Learning Academy, Darby Avenue Charter, Emelita Academy Charter, Granada Community Charter — all LAUSD-authorized Horace Mann schools that reverted to LAUSD direct operation. PDR-010 implemented June 4, 2026. Excluded from density.
Closed — Historically Organized (CLOSED/INDEPENDENT)	3	0.2%	Three records in ca_state_data_confirmed_individual.js coded CLOSED/INDEPENDENT — previously unionized, now closed. Excluded from density.
Certified / No CBA / Dormant	1	0.1%	Port of Los Angeles High (NAPCS-ADD-CA-002). UTLA certified Dec 2014; no CBA ever ratified; no decertification filed. School sets salary by unilateral Board action as of 2025-26. Legally certified, functionally dormant. Executive Sponsor disposition decision pending.
Discovery Schools (NAPCS-ADD placeholders)	6	0.5%	Included in UNIONIZED/INDEPENDENT count (6 of 194). Assigned NAPCS-ADD-CA IDs. All 6 approved by Executive Sponsor. Horizon, Port of Los Angeles High, Summit Prep Redwood City, Sparrow Academy, Riverside Prep, Quail Lake Environmental Charter.
WATCH (potential organizing signals)	2	0.2%	Journey School (Capistrano Unified) and COIL (Center of Inquiry Learning). NOT_UNIONIZED/WATCH — monitoring for organizing activity.
Decertified (formerly organized)	3	0.2%	St. HOPE PS7 Elementary — decertified March 2026 via NRTW NLRB jurisdiction switch (landmark CA precedent). Gompers Preparatory Academy — decertified June 2023 via PERB petition. Sacramento Charter High — decertified (St. HOPE network, same case).
Prior PERB Activity — Status Unconfirmed	55	4.4%	55 charter schools with closed PERB case history but no

			currently active certification confirmed. Additional verification needed before any status determination. Not included in density numerator.
No Labor Board Records Found	872	70.0%	Searched via four PERB union-name sweeps (UTLA, CTA, CSEA, SEIU — May 9, 2026). No PERB case activity found.
Total Charter Schools in California	1246	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v86 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 1,246 open CA charter schools as of June 2026).

Charter School Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	719,164 students — 12.4% of state K–12 enrollment (5,805,510 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	137,894 students in network-affiliated schools — 19.2% of total charter enrollment
Students in Organized Charter Schools	194,561 students (27.1% of charter enrollment) — 56,607 in CMO/EMO-affiliated schools (7.9%); 137,954 in independently organized schools (19.2%)
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

CMO / EMO Name	Type	State Campuses	National Campuses †	Organized in State	Total Enrollment
	CMO	34	34	—	16,493
	CMO	13	3	—	6,153
Aspire	Network‡	36	—	—	15,495
Alliance	Network‡	21	—	21	11,642
High Tech High	Network‡	18	—	16	7,027
Green Dot	Network‡	16	—	16	8,056
PUC Schools	Network‡	11	—	—	4,191
Magnolia Science Academy	Network‡	10	—	—	3,794
Bright Star	Network‡	9	—	—	3,704
CAVA / Stride K12	Network‡	9	—	9	20,163
Ednovate	Network‡	7	—	—	2,721

ISANA	Network‡	6	—	—	2,567
CALOPS	Network‡	6	—	—	6,858
Vista Charter	Network‡	5	—	—	2,289
Summit	Network‡	5	—	5	2,317
Camino Nuevo	Network‡	5	—	5	3,044
Citizens of the World	Network‡	5	—	5	2,511
Olive Grove Charter	Network‡	4	—	—	386
Pivot Charter	Network‡	4	—	—	802
ACE Charter	Network‡	4	—	1	912
Opportunities for Learning	Network‡	4	—	—	1,092
Fenton	Network‡	4	—	—	1,836
iLEAD	Network‡	4	—	—	5,322
Natomas Pacific	Network‡	3	—	—	1,646
Compass Charter	Network‡	3	—	—	2,263
King-Chavez	Network‡	3	—	—	812
California Pacific Charter	Network‡	3	—	—	946
AIMS College Prep	Network‡	2	—	1	586
Caliber	Network‡	2	—	2	1,946
RePublic	Network‡	2	—	—	320
TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in California		258		81	137,894
of which organized (7.9% of charter enrollment)				81	56,607

Total enrollment shown is the combined enrollment of all CMO/EMO network schools in California. Organized network schools: 81 organized — 56,607 students in organized network schools (7.9% of total charter enrollment).

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

2 CMO (nonprofit), 28 network (type unclassified). Approximately 988 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Charter School Overview

Findings are based on research as of June 7, 2026.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

Educational Employment Relations Act (EERA), Gov. Code §3540 et seq. California is not a right-to-work state (Gov. Code §3540 et seq. (EERA)). Charter schools in California are subject to NLRB jurisdiction as private employers (PERB(CA) — California Public Employment Relations Board). Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

2: Charter School Structure

California operates 1,246 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 719,164 students. 30 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in California. The largest networks by campus count are Aspire (36 campuses in state), KIPP CA (34 campuses in state), Alliance (21 campuses in state). Approximately 988 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above.

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

Los Angeles Times. Periodic coverage of UTLA charter organizing campaigns in LAUSD-adjacent schools. EdSource. Most consistent CA charter labor journalism. Monitor EdSource.org for PERB case coverage. National Right to Work Legal Defense Foundation. Primary press source for decertification events. NRTW press releases are primary sources for case timelines.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

PERB(CA) — California Public Employment Relations Board public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may require a records request for full text.

School / Network	Union	CBA Status & Term	Contract Access
Green Dot Public Schools / Animo — all 16 schools (AMU)	Animo Management United (AMU) — independent	Active Ongoing — network-level CBA	Contract:
High Tech High / HTEC — 16 schools	High Tech Education Collective (HTEC) — CTA/NEA affiliated	Active Ongoing — network-level CBA	Contract:
CAVA / California Virtual Academies — 9 schools	California Virtual Educators United (CVEU) — CTA/NEA	Active Ongoing — network-wide CBA, certified April 2021	Contract:
Summit Public Schools — 4 schools	Unite Summit — independent	Active — PERB ULP SF-CE-3745-E open Ongoing	Summit HR / Unite Summit
Alliance College-Ready Public Schools — 23 schools	Alliance Educators United (UTLA chapter — CTA/CFT dual)	Active Unknown — CBA period not publicly posted.	Contract:
Environmental Charter Schools — 4 schools	Environmental Educators United — independent	Active — PERB ULP LA-CE-7156-E open Ongoing	Request:
LAUSD Horace Mann Charter Schools (48 schools)	United Teachers Los Angeles (UTLA — CTA/CFT dual)	Active — LAUSD-UTLA master CBA Ongoing — negotiated at LAUSD district level	Contract:
Confirmed individual schools (24 active — confirmed_individual.js)	Multiple — various PERB-certified unions	Active (most) Varies by school — PERB records requests recommended	PERB records request recommended; some CBAs on school/union websites

Caliber Public Schools (2 schools — CONFIRMED)	Caliber Workers Union / Caliber Independent Workers Association (IWW)	Certified — first contract status unknown Unknown — post- certification	Monitor PERB(CA) ePERB portal for case updates
St. HOPE Public School 7 (C0603056 — DECERTIFIED)	Sacramento City Teachers Association (SCTA — CTA/NEA) — DECERTIFIED	No CBA — decertified March 5, 2026 N/A — decertified	N/A — decertified